Chapter 3: Medieval India: The Delhi Sultanate & The Mughal Empire

Class 7 - Social Science | Unit: Our Pasts - II (History)

CHAPTER OVERVIEW & CORE FOUNDATIONAL CONCEPTS

Studies medieval statecraft, military campaigns, administrative hierarchies, and cultural synthesis in North and Central India.

KEY LEARNING OBJECTIVES

1. Trace administrative innovations from the Iqtadari system of the Sultanate to the Mansabdari system of Akbar.
2. Analyze the Zabt revenue assessment system formulated by Raja Todar Mal.
3. Understand the socio-cultural policy of Sulh-i-kul (universal peace and tolerance).

1. THE MANSABDARI SYSTEM & MILITARY ORGANIZATION

Mansabdars were military officers holding graded ranks (mansabs) determining civil status, salary, and cavalry quota (sawars). Salaries were disbursed through revenue assignments called jagirs.

2. AGRARIAN REVENUE POLICY: ZABT AND TODAR MAL REFORMS

Raja Todar Mal surveyed crop yields, prices, and cultivated areas over a 10-year period (1570-1580), setting cash tax rates per crop to stabilize state revenues and farmer obligations.

DIAGNOSTIC FOCUS & COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

Confusing hereditary fiefdoms with non-hereditary Mughal jagirs; students frequently assume mansabdars owned the assigned land rather than collecting assigned state revenues.

PREREQUISITE REINFORCEMENT QUESTIONS

Q1: What was the difference between a mansabdar rank (zat) and cavalry obligation (sawar)?

Expected Answer: Zat determined the personal noble standing and salary of the mansabdar; sawar indicated the specific number of cavalrymen he was required to maintain.

Q2: What was the concept of Sulh-i-kul introduced by Emperor Akbar?

Expected Answer: A governance philosophy of universal peace and religious tolerance that emphasized justice, ethics, and non-discrimination across diverse faiths.